Compare a little water

A Kitchen Sponge

Name _____ Date _____

Show your thinking with numbers, marks, or words.

1. Little squeezes 32 millilitres of water into one cup and 47 into another. Which symbol compares the amounts?

32 ○ 47

Show your thinking.

2. Big measures 63 millilitres of water squeezed from a sponge. What is that amount rounded to the nearest ten?

63 → nearest ten: ___

Show your thinking.

3. A sponge soaks up 58 millilitres and a cloth soaks up 51 millilitres in a test. Which symbol compares the amounts?

58 ○ 51

Show your thinking.

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4. Little counts 25 visible holes in a close-up sponge sketch. What is that count rounded to the nearest ten?

25 → nearest ten: ___

Show your thinking.

5. Little counts 76 drops in one cup and 89 in another after a squeeze. Which symbol compares the counts?

76 ○ 89

Show your thinking.

6. The measuring cup holds 97 millilitres from several sponge squeezes. What is that amount rounded to the nearest ten?

97 → nearest ten: ___

Show your thinking.

WONDER DAILY

A Kitchen Sponge

Where did the water go?



Tiny holes. A big squeeze.

GRADE 3

Little Wonderer peered through a magnifier at a kitchen sponge. A sponge is a soft material that can take in water. "It is full of holes!" Little said. "Those holes are pores," said Big. Inside, many spaces connect like little tunnels. Little wondered where a spill would go.



Big dipped the sponge into a shallow dish. Its lower edge grew darker. Water clung to the sponge's walls and crept into narrow gaps. This slow spreading is called wicking. To soak up, or absorb, means to take water in. The water was entering the spaces inside.



Big lifted the sponge over an empty cup. "Where is the water now?" asked Little. Big gave a gentle squeeze: a press from both sides. The spaces became smaller, pushing water out. Drops fell into the cup. The water had not vanished. Little could see it again.



Next they compared two same-size pieces. One was bone-dry; the other was damp, with a little water already inside. Each met the same small spill for the same time. The damp piece soaked up its spill faster. That often happens, but different sponges can behave differently. A fair test helps us find out.

Make a little book.

1. Print one-sided: US Letter, portrait, actual size / 100%. No fit. Headers/footers off.
2. Fold long edge to long edge; reopen. Fold short edge to short edge, then in half again. Open: eight boxes.
3. Cut only the solid center line across the middle two boxes. Keep the outer boxes joined.
4. Refold long edge to long edge, print outside. Push ends together to open a diamond, then a cross.
5. Wrap into a book with page 1 in front. Follow pages 1 to 8.



Dip, squeeze, notice, and pause whenever you like.

Your turn

Write one command sentence about the sponge test.

Example: Dip the sponge in the water, then squeeze it over the empty cup.



"Is our sponge an animal?" Little asked. "Sea sponges are simple animals," said Big. "People make most kitchen sponges from cellulose, a plant fibre, or foam." Little drew holes in the notebook. "How much could ours hold?"



Big let go after another squeeze. The sponge began to spring back, returning to its open shape. Its spaces opened too, ready to take in water again. "Smaller, then open," Little said. The sponge changed shape, but the water stayed water. Little sketched the cup beside it.

Give a sponge test its words

A Kitchen Sponge · Curiosity day

Name _____ Date _____

Write one clear command for the sponge test. Say your sentence first if you like.



Water finds a way



A squeeze into the cup



Open again

Draw the sponge, its holes, and the cup. Add an arrow for the water.

dip · lift · squeeze · cup · holes · water · release · notice

First, ... tell how to dip the sponge in the dish

Then, ... tell how to squeeze it over the cup

At the end, ... tell how to let go and watch the shape

Does your sentence tell what to do, with a command such as Dip, Lift, Squeeze, or Release?